ENGLISH LANGUAGE PRACTICE WORKSHEET

Comprehensive Exercise Pack: Present Tense, Transitional Words, WH Questions & Reading Summaries

SECTION 0: PRESENT TENSE

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb in brackets.(Present Simple, Present Continuous, Present Perfect, or Present Perfect Continuous).

1. Please be quiet. The students ____ (take) a class test.
2. I ____ (read) this novel since last week, but I ____ (not/complete) it yet.
3. Water ____ (boil) at 100°C under normal conditions.
4. She ____ (live) in Dhaka for ten years, so she ____ (know) the city very well.
5. I ____ (read) this novel since last week, but I ____ (not/complete) it yet.
6. The students usually ____ (submit) their assignments online, but today they ____ (hand) them in to the teacher.
7. I ____ (know) Rima since we were in primary school.
8. My classmates ____ (prepare) for the presentation right now.
9. I ____ (not/meet) the new faculty member yet.
10. My brother rarely ____ (eat) fast food because he ____ (prefer) home-cooked meals.

SECTION 1: TRANSITIONAL WORDS

Fill in the blanks using the appropriate transitional words from the box provided for each set.

Set 1

nevertheless	moreover	but	because
unless	then	on the other hand	however

1. She dreads going to parties; _____, her husband loves meeting new people.

2. Ray’s apartment is always neat and clean, _____ the interior of his car looks like the aftermath of a tornado.
3. He completed his studies first; _____, he started his own business.
4. _____ you finish your work, you cannot go out to play.

Set 2

consequently	in addition	although	therefore
whereas	otherwise	for instance	meanwhile

1. The weather was extremely cold; _____, they decided to cancel the outdoor picnic.
2. _____ it was raining heavily, the dedicated team continued playing the match.
3. You must pay attention to the detailed instructions; _____, you might make a serious mistake.
4. He loves classical piano music, _____ his brother prefers modern rock and roll.

Set 3

furthermore	despite	as a result	in contrast
instead	since	similarly	finally

1. _____ the heavy traffic, we arrived at the international airport right on time.
2. The new library has thousands of printed books; _____, it offers free digital access to thousands of e-books.
3. He didn't study for the final exam; _____, he failed the course.
4. She decided not to order fast food; _____, she cooked a healthy dinner at home.

Set 4

besides	even though	thus	in comparison
likewise	provided that	subsequently	on the contrary

1. The company launched a great campaign; _____, sales increased by forty percent.
2. _____ he was tired, he stayed up late to finish his research paper.
3. The city center is very noisy; _____, the suburbs are calm and quiet.
4. You can borrow my car, _____ you return it with a full tank of gas.

Set 5

nonetheless	owing to	firstly	eventually
in summary	alternatively	namely	specifically

1. The flight was delayed _____ severe weather conditions over the mountains.
2. The task was remarkably difficult; _____, the team persevered and completed it.
3. After searching for three full hours, we _____ found the missing key in the drawer.
4. You can take the train; _____, you can rent a car to drive to the coast.

Set 6

whereas	in addition	hence	despite this
unless	meanwhile	for example	ultimately

1. Many fruits are rich in vitamins; _____, oranges contain high levels of Vitamin C.
2. The chef was busy preparing main courses; _____, the assistant chopped fresh vegetables.
3. He forgot his wallet at home; _____, he could not purchase the train ticket.
4. _____ you practice every single day, you won't master playing the violin.

Set 7

in fact	although	accordingly	to summarize
or else	as long as	notably	to begin with

1. He wasn't just helpful; _____, he saved the entire project from failing completely.
2. Please double-check your application form, _____ it might be rejected by the office.
3. _____ we were tired, we decided to walk along the beach before sleeping.
4. You may stay at our guest house _____ you keep the rooms clean and tidy.

Set 8

similarly	due to	above all	in other words
nonetheless	following this	in spite of	

1. The football match was postponed _____ torrential rain across the stadium.
2. Dogs require regular exercise and care; _____, cats need proper attention and nourishment.
3. He didn't pass the physical test; _____, he was not accepted into the police academy.
4. She failed her driving test three times; _____, she refused to give up hope.

Set 9

as well as	even if	thereafter	in short
to illustrate	on condition that	consequently	whereas

1. The museum features modern art _____ historical artifact exhibits.
2. I will support your business idea _____ it seems risky to invest right now.
3. He graduated from university in June; _____, he started working at a tech firm.
4. Many rare animals are endangered; _____, the snow leopard population is dropping fast.

Set 10

in contrast to	for this reason	furthermore	unless
meanwhile	in the same way	granted that	finally

1. _____ his brother who loves sports, David prefers reading literature books.
2. The car was old and kept breaking down; _____, they bought a reliable new one.
3. The new smartphone model has a better camera; _____, its battery life is much longer.
4. The scientist completed his experiment; _____, he published his findings in a journal.

Set 11

besides	however	since	as a consequence
conversely	first of all	provided	in summary

1. _____ you have completed all prerequisites, you can register for the course.
2. The hotel had fantastic online reviews; _____, our room was untidy and small.
3. He neglected his health for years; _____, he developed severe medical conditions.
4. _____, we must gather all necessary raw materials before beginning production.

Set 12

nonetheless	in light of	such as	otherwise
subsequently	whereas	likewise	because of

1. _____ recent events, the board decided to increase overall safety measures.
2. We should eat more vegetables, _____ spinach, broccoli, and fresh carrots.
3. Please lock the front door; _____, unwanted intruders might enter the house.
4. Fresh fruits are sweet, _____ lemons are extremely sour.

Set 13

despite	therefore	in addition to	while
indeed	as long as	hence	firstly

1. _____ playing the guitar, he is also an exceptionally skilled singer.
2. The candidate spoke with absolute confidence; _____, he impressed the panel.
3. _____ working full-time at a bank, she managed to earn a master's degree.
4. _____ some people enjoy winter sports, others prefer warm summer beaches.

Set 14

furthermore	however	because of	in brief
on the other hand	similarly	unless	then

1. The concert was cancelled _____ technical failure with the sound system.
2. Living in a big city is exciting; _____, it can be extremely expensive and stressful.
3. The team worked tirelessly; _____, they achieved all their annual goals.
4. _____ you save money every month, you won't be able to afford a vacation.

Set 15

as a result	whereas	in spite of	for instance
moreover	otherwise	subsequently	thus

1. _____ the loud noise outside, the baby slept peacefully throughout the night.
2. You must study hard for the entry test; _____, you will not get admission.
3. Green tea has antioxidant properties; _____, it helps improve human digestion.
4. Some people are naturally extroverted, _____ others are quiet and introverted.

Set 16

nevertheless	accordingly	owing to	besides
meanwhile	in contrast	finally	in order to

1. He worked hard _____ secure a full scholarship for his higher education.
2. The match was delayed _____ thick fog covering the entire football pitch.
3. The chef prepared the main dish; _____, the waiter set up the dining tables.
4. The prices increased significantly; _____, consumers reduced their spending.

Set 17

consequently	even though	such as	likewise
in fact	on the contrary	provided that	to sum up

1. She loved reading books; _____, her home library had over two thousand titles.
2. _____ he was severely injured, he managed to finish the marathon race.
3. He isn't lazy at all; _____, he is the most hardworking employee here.
4. You can stay out late, _____ you keep your phone turned on and answer calls.

Set 18

in addition	however	therefore	whereas
in case	as long as	subsequently	for example

1. Please carry an umbrella with you _____ it starts raining unexpectedly later.
2. The bakery sells fresh pastries; _____, it serves artisan coffee and tea.
3. The movie received poor reviews; _____, it made millions at the box office.
4. Dogs are extremely social animals, _____ cats tend to be more independent.

Set 19

despite	hence	furthermore	unless
meanwhile	in comparison	overall	for instance

1. _____ facing numerous financial difficulties, they successfully opened their restaurant.
2. The new solar panels generate clean energy; _____, they reduce electricity bills.
3. The company's profits dropped significantly; _____, they cut unnecessary expenses.
4. Solar power is renewable, _____ coal energy relies on finite natural reserves.

Set 20

as a result	although	on the other hand	because
otherwise	then	furthermore	notably

1. _____ she was feeling unwell, she attended the annual business meeting.
2. He forgot to set his alarm clock; _____, he woke up very late for work.
3. First, mix the dry ingredients in a bowl; _____, slowly pour in the fresh milk.
4. He loves tropical warm weather; _____, his wife prefers cold snowy winters.

SECTION 2: WH QUESTIONS

Focusing on the underlined phrases, make WH questions for the following sentences.

Set 1

1. The girl bought **a pair of shoes** from the market yesterday.
2. The farmers have been working in the field **for an hour**.
3. The teacher instructed **the students** to complete their home task in time.
4. A person needs **to exercise** regularly.

Set 2

1. She visits her grandmother **every Sunday morning**.
2. They cancelled the trip **because of the sudden heavy rain**.
3. The novel was written by **a famous author from England**.
4. He hid the surprise gift **under the bed**.

Set 3

1. My father bought **a sleek new laptop** last weekend.
2. She was crying **because she lost her favorite ring**.
3. The students gathered **in front of the main auditorium**.
4. The seminar will start **at 10:00 AM sharp**.

Set 4

1. They stayed in London **for three weeks** during the summer.
2. The doctor advised him **to drink plenty of water** daily.
3. She selected **the blue dress with silver flowers** for the party.
4. The mechanic fixed the broken engine **with special tools**.

Set 5

1. He gave the important document to **the project manager**.
2. The children were playing happily **in the back garden**.
3. She went to the grocery store **to buy fresh ingredients for dinner**.
4. The train arrives at the central station **every two hours**.

Set 6

1. The tourists were amazed by **the ancient historical architecture**.
2. He has been living in Paris **since 2018**.
3. The package was delivered by **the courier service**.
4. She solved the complex math problem **by using a new scientific method**.

Set 7

1. The company hired **five new software engineers** last month.
2. They decided to meet **at the local coffee shop**.
3. He failed the exam **because he did not study thoroughly**.
4. The baby sleeps **for ten hours** every night.

Set 8

1. She prefers **the red leather handbag** over the black one.
2. The artist painted the landscape **using vibrant watercolor paints**.
3. He called **his best friend** to share the good news.
4. The museum opens **at 9:00 AM every morning**.

Set 9

1. They went to the beach **to enjoy the sunset**.
2. The concert lasted **for nearly three hours**.
3. She put her house keys **inside the top desk drawer**.
4. The principal awarded **the top performing student** during assembly.

Set 10

1. He studies late at night **to prepare for his competitive exams**.
2. The bus stop is located **just across the street**.
3. She chose **the chocolate flavor** for her birthday cake.
4. The earthquake occurred **around midnight**.

Set 11

1. The little boy broke **the expensive crystal vase** by accident.
2. They have been waiting at the station **for over forty minutes**.
3. She sent the confidential letter to **her legal advisor**.
4. The athlete trains hard **to win the championship gold medal**.

Set 12

1. The family spends their winter vacation **in the snowy mountains**.
2. He repaired the leaking pipe **using heavy-duty sealant**.
3. The lecture was postponed **due to the professor's sudden illness**.
4. She visits her dentist **twice a year** for checkups.

Set 13

1. The chef prepared **a delicious three-course meal** for the guests.
2. The missing cat was found **hiding behind the wooden garage**.
3. He borrowed money from the bank **to start his tech enterprise**.
4. The conference will take place **next Thursday afternoon**.

Set 14

1. The committee elected **Sarah Jenkins** as the new president.
2. They completed the challenging marathon **in under four hours**.
3. She keeps her jewelry box **in the bedroom closet**.
4. He works hard **to support his family financially**.

Set 15

1. The store sells **imported organic vegetables** every morning.
2. The flight was delayed **owing to technical issues in the engine**.
3. She talked to **the customer service representative** on the phone.
4. The library is situated **next to the city hall**.

Set 16

1. He bought **a vintage sports car** at the auction yesterday.
2. The children played soccer **until it grew completely dark**.
3. She cleaned the dusty floor **with a damp microfiber cloth**.
4. They moved to Canada **to seek better career opportunities**.

Set 17

1. The manager praised **the marketing team** for their outstanding performance.
2. The historical monument was constructed **in the fifteenth century**.
3. He parked his bicycle **behind the library building**.
4. She felt sick **because she ate spoiled food at the market**.

Set 18

1. The dog barked loudly at **the unfamiliar mail carrier**.
2. They have been studying together **since early morning**.
3. She opened the locked wooden box **with a small silver key**.
4. He saved money **to buy a brand new smartphone**.

Set 19

1. The teacher explained **the complex scientific theory** with ease.
2. The accident happened **near the sharp highway curve**.
3. She called **her older sister** for emotional support.
4. The festival takes place **once every two years**.

Set 20

1. The company launched **an innovative mobile application** yesterday.
2. He was absent from work **because he had a severe fever**.
3. They found the lost keys **underneath the living room sofa**.
4. She practices yoga **for thirty minutes** every evening.

SECTION 3: SUMMARY WRITING

Write a summary of each of the following compositions. Copying words in exact sequence from the text will reduce your score.

Summary Set 1 Marks: 4

> **The Banyan Tree**
>
> The banyan tree is one of the most fascinating and unique trees in the world. It is widely found in tropical and subtropical regions, particularly in India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and Southeast Asia. This tree is easily recognizable due to its enormous structure, sprawling branches, and aerial roots that grow downward from its branches and eventually form new trunks. Over time, a single banyan tree can spread across vast areas, creating what appears to be an entire forest of interconnected trunks.
>
> In India, the banyan tree holds deep religious and cultural significance. It is considered sacred in Hinduism, Buddhism, and Jainism. Many temples and shrines are built beneath its shade, and people often gather under its branches for prayers, discussions, and social meetings. The banyan tree is also associated with longevity, wisdom, and stability, symbolizing eternal life in various traditions.
>
> Beyond its cultural importance, the banyan tree provides numerous practical benefits. Its dense canopy offers shelter to travelers, and many birds, monkeys, and insects make their homes in its branches. Additionally, its bark, leaves, and sap have medicinal properties and are used in traditional Ayurvedic medicine to treat ailments such as diabetes, skin infections, and digestive disorders.
>
> Some of the world's largest banyan trees have survived for hundreds of years, making them natural landmarks. For example, the Great Banyan Tree in Kolkata, India, is over 250 years old and covers several acres. Due to its resilience and longevity, the banyan tree is often seen as a symbol of endurance, strength, and unity, making it a treasured part of nature and human history.

Summary Set 2 Marks: 4

Honeybees and Ecosystem Preservation

Honeybees are among the most essential insects on Earth, playing an indispensable role in maintaining ecological balance and supporting global agricultural systems. Through the process of pollination, bees transfer pollen from the male parts of flowers to the female parts, enabling plants to reproduce, flower, and produce fruits and seeds. It is estimated that nearly one-third of the human food supply depends directly or indirectly on pollination by bees, including crops such as apples, almonds, berries, and cucumbers.

In addition to their agricultural contributions, honeybees are famous for their remarkably organized social structure. A single colony consists of thousands of worker bees, a few hundred drones, and a single queen bee. Each member has specific responsibilities vital to the hive's survival: worker bees forage for nectar and pollen, protect the hive, and produce honey, while the queen's primary role is laying thousands of eggs daily to maintain the population.

Despite their vital importance, bee populations worldwide face severe threats. Factors such as habitat loss due to urban development, widespread pesticide usage in industrial agriculture, climate change, and infectious diseases have led to significant declines in bee numbers—a phenomenon often referred to as Colony Collapse Disorder. Environmentalists emphasize that the collapse of bee populations would trigger catastrophic consequences for biodiversity and global food security.

Protecting honeybees requires urgent global and local actions. Planting native flowering plants, reducing chemical pesticide applications, supporting sustainable organic farming, and creating urban bee sanctuaries are crucial steps. Safeguarding these tiny pollinators is not merely about preserving honey production, but about ensuring the sustainability of entire terrestrial ecosystems and securing human survival.

Summary Set 3 Marks: 4

The History and Impact of the Printing Press

The invention of the movable type printing press by Johannes Gutenberg in the mid-15th century is widely regarded as one of the most transformative events in human history. Prior to Gutenberg's breakthrough, books were meticulously hand-copied by scribes, a painstaking process that made written materials extraordinarily rare, expensive, and accessible almost exclusively to royalty, wealthy elites, and religious institutions.

Gutenberg’s mechanical press revolutionized the production of literature by enabling books to be mass-produced quickly and affordably. The rapid dissemination of printed material fueled the European Renaissance, democratic movements, and the Scientific Revolution. Ideas that were once confined to small geographical regions or restricted circles could now spread across borders rapidly, encouraging literacy, critical thinking, and intellectual exchange among ordinary citizens.

Furthermore, the printing press laid the foundation for modern educational systems and journalism. The establishment of newspapers, academic journals, and public libraries transformed how information was gathered, verified, and shared. It democratized knowledge by stripping centralized authorities of their monopoly over information and allowed diverse voices and perspectives to flourish.

In conclusion, the legacy of the printing press extends far beyond the era of ink and paper. It established the paradigm of mass communication and information sharing that directly paved the way for the modern digital age. Gutenberg’s vision demonstrated that when knowledge is made accessible to all, human society accelerates in innovation, culture, and progress.

SECTION 0: PRESENT TENSE

1. are taking
2. have been reading; have not completed
3. boils
4. has been living; knows
5. have been reading; have not completed
6. submit; are handing
7. have known
8. are preparing
9. have not met
10. eats; prefers

SECTION 1: TRANSITIONAL WORDS ANSWERS

Set 1

1. however / on the other hand
2. but
3. then
4. Unless

Set 2

1. therefore / consequently
2. Although
3. otherwise
4. whereas

Set 3

1. Despite
2. furthermore
3. as a result
4. instead

Set 4

1. thus / as a result
2. Even though
3. in comparison / on the other hand
4. provided that

Set 5

1. owing to
2. nonetheless
3. eventually
4. alternatively

Set 6

1. for example
2. meanwhile
3. hence
4. Unless

Set 7

1. in fact
2. or else
3. Although
4. as long as

Set 8

1. due to
2. similarly
3. following this / as a result
4. nonetheless / in spite of this

Set 9

1. as well as
2. even if
3. thereafter
4. to illustrate

Set 10

1. In contrast to
2. for this reason
3. furthermore
4. finally

Set 11

1. Since / Provided
2. however
3. as a consequence
4. First of all

Set 12

1. In light of
2. such as
3. otherwise
4. whereas

Set 13

1. In addition to
2. hence / therefore
3. Despite
4. While

Set 14

1. because of
2. however / on the other hand
3. furthermore
4. Unless

Set 15

1. In spite of
2. otherwise
3. moreover / thus
4. whereas

Set 16

1. in order to
2. owing to
3. meanwhile
4. accordingly / consequently

Set 17

1. in fact
2. Even though
3. On the contrary
4. provided that

Set 18

1. in case
2. in addition
3. however
4. whereas

Set 19

1. Despite
2. furthermore
3. hence
4. whereas / in comparison

Set 20

1. Although
2. as a result
3. then
4. on the other hand

SECTION 2: WH QUESTIONS ANSWERS

Set 1

1. What did the girl buy from the market yesterday?
2. How long have the farmers been working in the field?
3. Whom did the teacher instruct to complete their home task in time?
4. What does a person need to do regularly?

Set 2

1. When does she visit her grandmother?
2. Why did they cancel the trip?
3. By whom was the novel written?
4. Where did he hide the surprise gift?

Set 3

1. What did your father buy last weekend?
2. Why was she crying?
3. Where did the students gather?
4. What time will the seminar start?

Set 4

1. How long did they stay in London during the summer?
2. What did the doctor advise him to do daily?
3. Which dress did she select for the party?
4. How did the mechanic fix the broken engine?

Set 5

1. To whom did he give the important document?
2. Where were the children playing happily?
3. Why did she go to the grocery store?
4. How often does the train arrive at the central station?

Set 6

1. What were the tourists amazed by?
2. How long has he been living in Paris? / Since when has he been living in Paris?
3. By whom was the package delivered?
4. How did she solve the complex math problem?

Set 7

1. How many software engineers did the company hire last month?
2. Where did they decide to meet?
3. Why did he fail the exam?
4. How long does the baby sleep every night?

Set 8

1. Which handbag does she prefer over the black one?
2. How did the artist paint the landscape?
3. Whom did he call to share the good news?
4. When does the museum open every morning?

Set 9

1. Why did they go to the beach?
2. How long did the concert last?
3. Where did she put her house keys?
4. Whom did the principal award during assembly?

Set 10

1. Why does he study late at night?
2. Where is the bus stop located?
3. Which flavor did she choose for her birthday cake?
4. When did the earthquake occur?

Set 11

1. What did the little boy break by accident?
2. How long have they been waiting at the station?
3. To whom did she send the confidential letter?
4. Why does the athlete train hard?

Set 12

1. Where does the family spend their winter vacation?
2. How did he repair the leaking pipe?
3. Why was the lecture postponed?
4. How often does she visit her dentist for checkups?

Set 13

1. What did the chef prepare for the guests?
2. Where was the missing cat found hiding?
3. Why did he borrow money from the bank?
4. When will the conference take place?

Set 14

1. Whom did the committee elect as the new president?
2. How long did it take them to complete the marathon?
3. Where does she keep her jewelry box?
4. Why does he work hard?

Set 15

1. What does the store sell every morning?
2. Why was the flight delayed?
3. Whom did she talk to on the phone?
4. Where is the library situated?

Set 16

1. What did he buy at the auction yesterday?
2. How long did the children play soccer?
3. How did she clean the dusty floor?
4. Why did they move to Canada?

Set 17

1. Whom did the manager praise for their outstanding performance?
2. When was the historical monument constructed?
3. Where did he park his bicycle?
4. Why did she feel sick?

Set 18

1. At whom did the dog bark loudly?
2. How long have they been studying together? / Since when have they been studying together?
3. How did she open the locked wooden box?
4. Why did he save money?

SECTION 3: SUMMARY WRITING SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Suggested Answer for Set 1: The Banyan Tree

The banyan tree, prevalent in tropical Asia, is distinguished by its vast structure and descending aerial roots that create connected trunk systems. Sacred across multiple faiths, it hosts social gatherings and symbolizes stability and endurance. Beyond cultural value, its large canopy shelters wildlife and travelers, while its various parts serve medicinal purposes in Ayurveda. Living for centuries, iconic specimens like Kolkata’s Great Banyan represent strength, unity, and ecological significance.

Suggested Answer for Set 2: Honeybees and Ecosystem Preservation

Honeybees are essential pollinators that enable plant reproduction and sustain roughly a third of human food production. They live in highly structured colonies comprising a queen, drones, and specialized worker bees. However, global bee populations are severely declining due to urban expansion, pesticide reliance, climate change, and diseases. Protecting them through native planting, reduced chemical usage, and organic farming is critical for global agricultural stability and ecosystem survival.

Suggested Answer for Set 3: The History and Impact of the Printing Press

Johannes Gutenberg's 15th-century movable type printing press transformed society by replacing labor-intensive hand copying with affordable mass production of literature. This innovation democratized information, sparking the Renaissance, Scientific Revolution, and democratic movements by spreading knowledge to the general public. Additionally, it established modern education and journalism, creating a framework for global mass communication that ultimately laid the foundation for today's digital information age.